

The site is located on the east side of Post Road (US Route 1). Abutting South of the site are the Fairfield Inn & Suites and to the west is T.F Green Airport. To the north is a currently unoccupied property that was formerly the Sheraton Providence Airport Hotel.



Aerial View of the Site

This site was formerly the location of the Valle's Steak House restaurant. Under existing conditions, Lot 336 is almost entirely paved as it serves as a parking lot.

Topography and Drainage – The site is generally flat with a small amount of relief from Post Road to the east. There is approximately 15 feet of grade change across the site from east to west.

It seems that existing stormwater is generally contained on site and a small depression along the eastern side of the site with some flowing offsite to the south and east.

Soils – The soils on the site have been mapped by the USDA Natural Resource Conservation Service. See the image below. Soils onsite been identified as Ur Udorthent – Urban Land Complex.



Existing Utilities – There are public water and sewer available in Post Road and the water and sewer departments have indicated that service are adequate for the development.

Zoning – The subject parcel is zoned G (Gateway). Properties within this district are intended to serve as transitional areas leading to the Intermodal District of the Warwick Station Development District from outlying areas, including the Post Road and Airport Road general business districts. The Gateway District is intended to allow limited commercial use customarily associated with transportation facilities as well as general commercial uses commonly allowed within general business districts. It is intended that this zone has a high quality of design associated with vehicular circulation and appropriate landscaping and architectural design intended to create a separate identity and a cohesive appearance distinguishable from the outlying areas.

The parcels abutting the site are zoned G (Gateway), LI (Light Industrial).

Proposed Use – The current proposal, as shown on the accompanying site plans, consists of two residential buildings with a total of 177 residential units.



The two buildings are proposed to be four total stories and will not exceed the 75' height requirement. The unit mix will be a mixture of one-bedrooms and two-bedroom units. The Applicant is proposing that 10% of the units be restricted as affordable with an Area Median Income (AMI) of 80% or lower and 10% of the units be restricted as workforce housing which are restricted to AMIs of between 80% and 120%.

The site plan proposes a total of 266 parking spaces. This would result in a parking ratio of 1.5 spaces per unit which meets the Gateway District requirement of 1.5 spaces per unit. A traffic analysis has been completed by Pare Engineering and is included with this submission and it indicated that the traffic generated by this development can be accommodated safely and will have minimal impact on the surrounding traffic conditions.

The site will be served by public water and sewer located in Post Road. Stormwater on the site will be collected and conveyed to underground stormwater systems which will provide both water quality treatment, peak mitigation control and infiltration. From previous soil investigations completed at an adjacent site, it is known that the soils and groundwater conditions present are suitable for this type of stormwater approach. The stormwater approach will meet the City of Warwick and Rhode Island Department of Environmental Management requirements.

In general, the landscaping approach will be to consult the City of Warwick City Center Design Guidelines and establish a streetscape along Post Road. Interior to the site, landscaping around the buildings and within the parking field will meet the City of Warwick requirements and provide shading for the parking area and be utilized to create useable outdoor spaces for residents.

Building Architecture and Appearance:

The architectural design of the buildings focuses on integrating modern materials in a style that balances distinctive design while considering the long-term impacts of design trends. The two four-story buildings will have strong similarities in design to provide continuity and identity.



All the façade materials for walls, windows, and doors are characterized as acceptable materials. Horizontal and vertical articulation fall within the Design Standards, including rhythmic patterns of bays, a differentiated first floor, and the proportion of openings. The building height is also aligned with the Standards, as is utility placement.

Common spaces are oriented to best activate the site entry, near the probable future pedestrian node, and the outdoor recreation spaces between the buildings are centrally located within the site. The building façades contain bay windows which are oriented to the street along the façade, helping to provide visual interest and a distinctive architectural expression.

Signage consists of monument signs placed at each entry. These are made of high-quality masonry designed to complement the architectural character of the buildings.

Building Placement and Massing:

The first building was intentionally situated along the street. This layout endeavors to enhance the pedestrian experience, while also shielding the surface parking to the interior of the site. The second building has been located in the interior of the site in order to break up the parking and also locate parking in a manner where it is distributed around both buildings.

The parking will meet the Design Manual standards. Sidewalks have been included in the site design and will connect to existing sidewalks along Post Road. Parking and dumpsters are fully buffered from public view.

Conclusion

The market for new housing is constrained across the nation and of course in Warwick. As this need continues to build, the lack of new projects is coming to a standstill. Limited availability of sites in locations where people want to live are becoming scarce.

By building density in this location the project is able to answer those problems. This site is perfectly suited to add housing in Warwick due to its location near transportation hubs, job centers and shopping. By keeping density low for this site, it would be giving up the opportunity to locate housing in an area that can handle the demand and supplement the existing investments already made in Warwick.

If you have any further questions on this matter, please feel free to contact me at your earliest convenience.

Sincerely,
DiPrete Engineering Associates, Inc.

A handwritten signature in black ink, appearing to read "Brandon Carr".

Brandon Carr, PE, LEED AP
Principal
bcarr@diprete-eng.com